BRENTON GRAY

SOFTWARE ENGINEER | MARINE VETERAN

CONTACT

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Portfolio: brenton-j-gray.github.io/portfolio

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

National University
June 2021 - June 2025
GPA 3.6/4.0
Cum Laude

SKILLS

- Java
- C++
- JavaScript (React, Node, Express)
- Python / C#
- React Native
- SQL
- MongoDB
- MySQL
- Azure DevOps
- CI/CD
- GitHub / Git
- RESTful APIs
- OOP
- Unreal Engine

INTERESTS

Large Language Models (LLM), Machine Learning (ML), Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG), Audio/Music Production, A/V processing, Game Design/Development

CERTIFICATIONS

Current: Lean Six Sigma - Yellow Belt | United States Marine Corps | Apr 2024

Continuous Growth: Epic Unreal Engine Fundamentals, UC-Berkley DSA

SUMMARY

Software engineer and U.S. Marine Veteran actively transitioning to full-time software engineering, with active industry experience building production distributed systems at Microsoft. Holds a B.S. in Computer Science (Cum Laude) and a portfolio of independently built projects across C++, React Native, and real-time networked systems. Brings 20 years of technical problem-solving, cross-team collaboration, servant leadership, and systems thinking under pressure. Collaborative by nature, clear communicator, and driven by a growth mindset that translates complex requirements into working software. U.S. Citizen with active Secret clearance.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Microsoft

Software Engineer Fellow | Jan 2026 - Present

- Resolved repo/tool access, entitlements, and permissions to complete onboarding and start shipping engineering work.
- Built proficiency with XJPL automation and investigated ART billing-anomaly IcMs to accelerate incident triage and RCA.
- Navigated access packages and secure-environment constraints to obtain required approvals and contribute to internal engineering deliverables.

United States Marine Corps

Senior Technical Program Manager | Mar 2006 – Mar 2026

- Diagnosed and resolved failures across interdependent electronics and communications systems, sustaining 99%+ mission-capable rates on communication and electronic systems.
- Authored technical documentation and drove process improvements that cut compliance findings by ~15% and shortened certification prep cycles by ~1 week.
- Managed cross-functional teams and coordinated end-to-end maintenance operations across 20+ years; reduced average turnaround time by ~10% and maintained 90%+ on-time completion through systematic tracking and resource allocation.

PROJECTS

PortList (React Native, Expo | Aug 2025): Cross-platform offline-first app with secure auth; built CRUD, local persistence, and sync/session management.

WasteNot (MERN Stack | Feb 2025): 5-person team; meal-planning app; built Node/Express REST APIs with MongoDB/MySQL, validation, tests, S3-compatible object storage, and React mapping UI.

LANjam (C++, OpenGL | Oct 2025): Real-time P2P audio prototype for low-latency LAN collaboration; implemented peer discovery, OpenGL rendering, and timing/jitter correction for cross-peer sync.

TicTacToe (C++, SFML | Feb 2026): Built a deterministic finite state machine with clean separation of rules/state/I-O, plus input validation for extensibility (e.g., AI).

UE5 Project (Unreal Engine, Blueprints, C++ | Jan 2026): Solo UE5 game-systems architecture work: event-driven AI, data-driven config, and modular components.